The Sound Of Silence

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/44716645.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Netossa/Spinnerella (She-Ra)

Character:
Netossa (She-Ra), Spinnerella (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Fluff, Hurt/Comfort, Mild Angst, Injury, Permanent Injury, Deaf Netossa, Deaf Character, Trauma, Post-War, Sharing a Bed, Cuddles, Married Couple, Magic, Disabled Character

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by TheStarGayzingEtherian

Summary

Many years ago, during her early days in the rebellion, Netossa lost her hearing in a mission gone wrong. Now though, she's managed to live with her deafness… largely thanks to her wife being there for her. (Spinetossa, Canon, Hurt/Comfort)

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

“Darling, are you coming to bed?” Spinnerella asked.

“Just a moment, Spinny,” Netossa replied, looking at herself in the bathroom mirror. She sighed, reaching up to the silver earpieces she wore around the shells of her ears, gently removing them and placing them down on the surface in front of her.

As they were removed, the whole world suddenly went quiet, no noise, not even the rustling of the wind outside of hers and Spinnerella’s cottage. Everything was silent and as Netossa sighed, she felt herself at peace, her home being the only place she felt safe being this way. It was ironic. For all her tactical skills and fearless persona, Netossa on the inside was a woman who often felt vulnerable and weak.

The earpieces were magically enhanced hearing aids. Without them, Netossa was completely deaf. She hadn’t been born this way though, no, she’d lost her hearing differently that other deaf people like herself, a painful tragedy that had taught her the consequences of her often stubborn and reckless actions.

Her mind then flashed back to the day when her life had changed, when nothing was ever the same again.

It was during one of her and Spinnerella’s first deployments after they became active members of the Rebellion, the two of them having already been together for several years. A Horde battalion was attacking a nearby town and Netossa had been desperate for some action.

She was a lot more headstrong back then, always looking for a chance to head into battle. One couldn’t blame her since she’d personally watched the Horde slay her family before their eyes as they brought her kingdom to ruins. It wouldn’t be until later in life that Netossa became the cunning, careful strategist everyone else knew her as.

But back then, cocky was her middle name.

The Horde's forces were entrenched deep, the local rebel fighters only barely pushing them back, until Netossa and her squad arrived and then, the townspeople had a fighting chance. For Netossa, it was almost too easy. She'd honed her powers for years and in those early days, she felt completely unstoppable.

And then everything changed. As she was tossing her nets as a squad of Horde soldiers, she noticed Spinnerella up in the air above her, blasting cyclones of wind to knock the Horde forces back. Her at-the-time girlfriend always found some way to awe Netossa with her powers.

However, Netossa then saw a Horde soldier take a shot at Spinnerella with a laser rifle, shooting her straight out of the sky. She remembered screaming as she watched Spinnerella fall to the ground. Fortunately, she was able to catch her with one of her nets but her wife had been badly hurt.

Desperately, she'd grabbed Spinnerella and ran her into a nearby house, remembering some of the last sounds she'd heard with her own natural ears being the laser bolts that narrowly missed them. They held out in the house for what seemed like an age… but then, the Horde soldiers got impatient and decided to smoke them out.

One of them chucked a sonic pulse grenade right into the house, a weapon that would have likely killed both of them had it not been for Netossa's quick thinking, covering the grenade with one of her nets. However, it only barely contained the explosion, bringing the entire house down on top of her and Spinnerella.

It wasn't until later that, after the Horde soldiers had left the town, a rebel team led by Queen Angella found the two of them in the rubble beneath the house. Miraculously, they'd managed to survive, but Netossa was left with permanent damage to her eardrums from taking the blast of the grenade head-on.

Everyone had kept telling that it wasn't her fault, that she was a hero for saving Spinnerella's life, but all Netossa could think of

was how arrogant and cocky she'd been, focusing too much on the battle and not on her team until it was too late. She often remarked how she felt lucky to have lost only her hearing and not her heart.

Since then, Netossa began planning for every eventuality, giving her a reputation as a tactical genius that she became known for her. As far as Netossa was concerned, as long as she was drawing breath, she would never let a tragedy like the one that had happened to her happen to anyone else again.

The earpieces did help with Netossa's deafness, but a lot of the time they gave her splitting headaches, which were only barely tempered with medication. Quite a lot of the time, she didn't wear them, mostly when she was alone like this with her wife or the two were out on a date together.

Netossa didn't truly need to hear for moments like that, to just shut out the world and enjoy herself. And if she did have to communicate with anyone, well, Spinnerella was a master at understanding Etherian sign language. If Netossa needed anything, her wife was more than happy to translate for her.

However, with the war over, Netossa pondered if she honestly wanted to keep wearing her earpieces. She probably could have gotten some kind of surgery to restore her hearing by this point, Etheria was a world of medical marvels after all. But Netossa had adapted to being without her hearing for so many years, why bother going back?

Yes, it may have been a tragedy that took her hearing away… but Netossa wouldn't change who she was now. She had accepted herself, she was happy with herself. Which led to the discussion she'd had with herself about keeping the earpieces. She and Spinnerella were likely going to just be living the quiet life together after the war, mostly undisturbed.

Of course, there would be the odd party or royal function they'd be asked to attend, but Netossa was comfortable with that.

Truthfully, during most of the parties and royal balls she'd been to, she'd mostly just hung around her wife for most of the evening, of which Spinnerella had no complaints about.

Looking at herself in the mirror, Netossa rubbed her weary eyes. It was time for bed. She picked up her earpieces and walked into the bedroom, where her wife was waiting for her, her dazzling eyes full of love for her. Sighing, Netossa placed her earpieces on the bedside table before climbing inside.

As she got onto the bed, Spinnerella cupped her cheeks and kissed her softly, telling her all she needed to know without even needing to say a single word. She sighed in contentment, feeling Spinnerella's embrace as she was pulled down, her beautiful wonder wife not stopping in kissing her.

As they lay in their bed, Spinnerella caressing Netossa's cheek, Netossa smiled, looking into the eyes of the woman she loved. It may have been a reckless action that robbed her of her hearing, she wouldn't deny that… but at the same time, her wife was there and they were safe and happy, what couldn't be more important.

She looked at her wife's lips, watching them mouth "I love you". Netossa admittedly hadn't gotten that good at lip reading. She was good at reading people's emotions based on their faces, but their lips… no, even she wasn't that good. She spoke in reply, saying "I love you too," but of course, not being able to hear her own words.

Wrapping up under the blankets, Netossa allowed herself to be spooned, feeling the warm arms of her wife wrap around her waist, Spinnerella resting her head on her wife's shoulder as they began to drift off. Netossa sighed dreamily, closing her eyes and allowing herself to relax.

No matter the trials of her life and all she'd been through, Netossa was glad that Spinnerella had been a constant, that no matter what, she would always be there for her.

End Notes

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